Mark Scheme — Vocabulary Test 12

English Language 1123
By Miss Jaweria

Section A — Vocabulary in Context

(a) 'cautiously approached' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('cautiously') carefully / slowly / warily / nervously / watchfully / with caution
- ('approached') came near / moved towards / went closer / walked up to / drew near

Guidance: Do NOT credit "walked" alone. LOOK FOR care and wariness.

(b) 'breathlessly announced' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('breathlessly') panting / gasping / out of breath / unable to breathe properly
- ('announced') declared / told / reported / proclaimed / stated

Guidance: LOOK FOR physical breathlessness, not excitement.

Section B — Word Choice

(c) 'devastation' rather than 'damage' **[1 mark]**

- devastation suggests total, overwhelming destruction / nothing left intact // damage is mild and partial; devastation implies everything has been destroyed

Guidance: LOOK FOR completeness of destruction.

(d) 'fateful' rather than 'unfortunate' **[1 mark]**

- fateful suggests something decided by fate / destiny / of great and lasting consequence // unfortunate just means unlucky; fateful implies a turning point that was meant to happen

Guidance: LOOK FOR destiny or lasting consequence.

Section C — Writer's Effect

(e) 'mysteriously' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- something strange / unexplained / puzzling is happening / without reason
- it is eerie / supernatural / ghostly / unnatural / spooky
- creates suspense / curiosity // the reader feels intrigued / uneasy / scared

Guidance: Focus on the unexplained quality. NOT: dark alone.

(f) 'speculation' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- people are guessing / making theories / not sure what happened
- there is uncertainty / confusion / no one knows the truth
- creates intrigue / tension // the reader feels curious / uncertain

Guidance: LOOK FOR uncertainty and guesswork.

Section D — Word Bank Answers

(g) volunteered — Offered willingly / stepped forward
(h) combed — Searched thoroughly / scoured
(i) investigate — Examine / look into / probe
(j) mishap — Accident / misfortune / unlucky event

Distractors (unused): severe, crucial

Mark Breakdown:

Section A (a-b)	4
Section B (c-d)	2
Section C (e-f)	4
Section D (g-j)	6
TOTAL	**16**